



IN A FINANCIAL services landscape fraught with interest rate and liquidity risks, India's banking sector currently finds itself at a crossroads. The sudden decline in the share of low-cost current account and savings account (CASA) deposits is forcing banks to rethink their strategies. To attract funds, these lenders may need to raise deposit rates—a move that risks narrowing net interest margins (NIMs) and squeezing profitability. Simultaneously, surging unsecured loans now face tighter capital requirements from the Reserve Bank of India (RBI). And the micro-loans segment—once seen as a goldmine of fresh credit—is grappling with rising delinquencies, signalling a turning credit cycle. The stock market valuations of banking, financial services and insurance (BFSI) players, too, have corrected in a big way with the sector underperforming in the market.

This is the high-stakes environment in which banks and non-banking financial companies or NBFCs often operate as cycles turn, where navigating a delicate balance between growth, cost efficiency, and customer service becomes the key differentiator. There are some players that have not only endured these headwinds but have excelled. The BT-KPMG Survey of India's Best Banks and NBFCs for 2023-24 shines a spotlight on these stars of resilience and innovation, celebrating their

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JURY WINNERS

► BANK OF THE YEAR

ICICI Bank

► LIFETIME ACHIEVEMENT AWARD

Dinesh Kumar Khara, Former Chairman, SBI

► BEST BANK IN INNOVATION

SBI

► BEST BANK IN TALENT & WORKFORCE

Axis Bank

► BEST NBFC IN INNOVATION

Aditya Birla Capital

► BEST NBFC IN TALENT & WORKFORCE

Mahindra Finance

► BEST FINTech IN PAYMENTS

MobiKwik

► BEST FINTech IN VALUE-ADDED SERVICES

Jocata

► BEST FINTech IN LENDING

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